

Council Meeting
March 26, 2025
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, March 26, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski - Absent
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept the minutes of the March 12, 2025, City Council meeting.

Councilor Hemingway noted the discussion was light for the Policy Commission also the opposition for permission to ask the attorney about Class VI roads.

Voice vote:

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – no

Hemingway – no

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – yes
Motion carried 5-3

MAYOR'S NOTES

The Claremont Neighborhood Watch Project is having its first meeting tomorrow night at the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center in room B at 6:00 p.m.

Stevens High School will be holding their senior play 'Clue' preformed this Friday and Saturday.

There is a public meeting on Tuesday April 8th at 5:30 p.m. at the Community Center on South Street for the Veterans Tennis and Pickleball Courts.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Makerspace has been partnering with SRVTC and RVCC to launch Trade Up Claremont a workforce development program funded by the CMS Northern Borders Grant.

The City's new Human Resource Director Shannon Thibodeau will be joining us on Monday.

Project updates:

North Street project is scheduled to resume on March 31st, there will be a bi-weekly meeting during the project duration which will allow for updates to the Council and public. Traffic message boards will be out a few days ahead to notify the public of the construction

Tennis and pickle ball courts – Pine Hill Construction has started the excavation portion of the project. Parks and Recreation are in discussion with LWCF regarding additional items that may be included in the project.

The Fire Department driveway paving project - Zullo Construction met with the Chief and indicated a start date of April 28th depending on weather the project is anticipated to last two weeks. The fire apparatuses will be at DPW during this period.

A new private hangar development at Claremont Municipal Airport is nearing completion, with a site review phase underway and a lease agreement is in place, and construction is set to begin in early spring.

Mayor Girard questioned the lease agreement being in place and not coming in front of Council. Manager Manale noted there may be a lease agreement in place and will bring it to Council and it has not been signed.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Jack Hurley, Ward II, read that the federal government froze federal funds including the funds for the improvement of water quality, and flooding to the Connecticut River along with not funding the New Hampshire Food Bank, and asked what the best way for the City to inform the community.

OLD BUSINESS

Resolution 2025-33 79-E Application 109 Pleasant St. – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to take Resolution 2025-33 off the table.

Roll call:

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

RESOLUTION 2025-33

**Application for RSA 79-E Community Revitalization Tax Relief Incentive
for
Substantial Rehabilitation of 109 Pleasant Street**

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City Council passed Resolution 2016-11 on July 22, 2015, adopting the provisions of RSA 79-E, Community Revitalization Tax Relief Incentive, as further amended by Resolution 2019-8 and as readopted by Resolution 2021-13; and

WHEREAS on December 27, 2024, the City received an application from Mitchell Pauly, Trustee of Pauly Family Trust, seeking property tax relief under the provisions of RSA 79-E as incentive for substantial rehabilitation for property located at 109 Pleasant Street (the “Property”); and

WHEREAS the Property is located within the City’s 79-E Incentive District; and

WHEREAS Mitchell Pauly, Trustee of Pauly Family Trust, plans to invest approximately \$247,000.00 to substantially rehabilitate the Property; and

WHEREAS the City Council has determined that the application has met the requirements of RSA 79-E:14 and has determined that the construction cost for the proposed commercial building shall not result in the use of government grants and funds whereby such funds would total 50% or more of the project’s construction cost; and

WHEREAS the City Council finds that the application satisfies all applicable provisions of RSA 79-E and is eligible pursuant to RSA 79-E:5, I for a Community Tax Relief Incentive for a period up to seven (7) years, beginning with the completion of the substantial rehabilitation of the Property.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby determines the proposed project has a public benefit in accordance with RSA 79-E:7, I, II, II-a, and III; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED the City Council herein approves the application for tax relief for a period of seven (7) years per RSA 79-E:5, I, commencing upon the completion of the substantial rehabilitation of the Property as evidenced by the issuance of a Certificate of Occupancy; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the granting of this Community Tax Relief Incentive is subject to the granting by Mitchell Pauly, Trustee of Pauly Family Trust, of a covenant, acceptable to legal counsel, in accordance with RSA 79-E:8, ensuring that the property shall be maintained and used in a manner that furthers the public benefits for which the tax relief was granted and such other requirements as are set forth in Resolution 2016-11; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that if the covenant is terminated for any reason, the City shall assess all current and arrears taxes to the owner as though no tax relief was granted, with interest, in accordance with RSA Chapter 75; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. (*Majority Vote Required*)

Dated this 26th day of March, 2025, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

Austin Ford, City Planner, explained application and noted the applicant Mitchell Pauly is asking for ten years of relief but is qualified for seven, this discussion will be for up to 7 years of relief.

The applicant noted this plan was approved by Planning Board and explained there are three units going in on the second floor, and two on the third floor for a total of five units.

Councilor Greenrose asked what the apartment count is currently, the applicant stated zero, and the third floor has been vacant for years.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked if these units will be market rate rents, the applicant replied yes.

Councilor Hemingway asked if the property has any lead problems, the applicant replied there have been no issues with lead.

City Planner Ford stated the Planning Board is through the reviewing period and ready to issue permits.

Mr. Pauly stated the project itself should take between three and five months.

Based upon what the applicant stated Mayor Girard suggested a date of March 31st, 2026 for a completion date.

City Planner Ford noted the previous 79-E had a start date of July 1st of this year and March 31st of the following year for a completion date.

Mayor Girard asked if Mr. Pauly was okay with this, Mr. Pauly stated he feels he could get it done before March but likes the idea of holding the completion date until what was suggested.

Mayor Girard asked thoughts from Council about time frames.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated seven years is fair. Councilor Zutter agrees

Councilor Hemingway asked what was on the bottom floor, Mr. Pauly noted it was 2 commercial tenants.

Councilor Hemingway then stated he was thinking five years but maybe push it to seven if that's how the rest of Council feels.

Mayor Girard asked if that meant he agreed.

Hemingway clarified that his thoughts on the five apartments, with no outside work to be done and the scope of the work, he was going to recommend five years but being that location, he feels he may be able to push it to seven depending on the rest of council but was heading towards the five mark.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept Resolution 2025-33.

Resolution 2025-33 was read into the record by Councilor Hayden

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – no

Girard – yes

Motion carried 7-1

NEW BUSINESS

Capital Reserve and Expendable Trust Fund Review and Cleanup Discussion

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to take Capital Reserve and Expendable Trust Fund Review and Cleanup Discussion off the table.

Roll call:

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Memorandum

To: Yoshi Manale, Claremont City Manager

From: Nancy Bates, Finance Director

Date: 2025-03-20

Re: Review of Capital Reserves

The City Treasurer and I have reviewed the City’s capital reserve accounts held by the Trustees of Trust Funds. We have identified several accounts we recommend for closure due to inactivity and/or low balances. Many of these accounts were set up for very specific purposes and simply have some small amounts of residual funds, and some we were unable to find an establishing motion or resolution.

We have attached 1) a list of all the City’s capital reserves in custody of the Trustees of Trust Funds with their balance as of 2/28/25, and 2) a list of capital reserves we would like the Council to consider closing.

If the Council chooses to close any or all these accounts, we will present a resolution to do so at a future meeting.

We also suggest the establishment of two new funds:

Healthcare Stabilization	To stabilize healthcare costs by transferring the entire budgeted amount for health insurance to an account from which the liability is paid. Any residual remains in this fund to offset rate increases and/or changes in coverage during the year. The budget is then determined based on average costs over a period with consideration of the stabilization fund balance and the percentage of increase set by the insurance company. This annualizes health insurance expenditures and reduces spikes in years when rates rise significantly.
Cyclical Revaluation	The City is required by State law to perform a revaluation at least once every 5 years. It costs approximately \$250,000 per revaluation. Placing \$50,000 of fund balance, if it is available, into a fund each year will help to avoid a \$250,000 spike in the budget every 5 years. This annualizes the revaluation expense.

Director Bates explained Capital Reserve and Expendable Trust Fund Review and Cleanup.

Director Bates noted there are recommendations for additions and recommendations for closures.

Additions:

Director Bates recommends a healthcare stabilization fund, by moving the entire budgeted amount to a fund and pay the liability out of that then what ever is left stays as a residual in that fund and will help stabilize health insurance costs the following year.

Cyclical re-evaluation fund, Director Bates explained every five years the City is required to do a re-evaluation on properties, and it's about a quarter of a million dollars the thought is to put \$50,000.00 in every year so on the fifth year the City will have the funds to cover the expense, and the budget wont spike due to the eval that year.

Closures:

Several funds that were established for specific purposes by resolution 2010-12. However, the resolution itself did not have any specific language in it about establishing capital reserves or trust funds. Director Bates spoke with the DRA and stated these funds should not be in custody of the trustees they were originally special revenue funds and the suggestion is that the City use these funds for the intentions they were given and then close the following accounts:

FBOTTF Parks and Recreation Community Center Building, which there is already a non-capital reserve for this.

Director Bates stated these are residual funds from the fundraising the City did when they first built the new Community Center and recommends transferring these monies into the maintenance and repair reserve for the community center and close this account.

City Enhancement

Director Bates explained there is very little money in the fund and can find no record of a vote for a motion to establish this fund, and is unaware of how the money got to the trustees, the

recommendation would be to close this account and move the money to the general fund non-trustee account, which is an investment account of excess fund balance.

Director Bates noted the next five accounts established by Resolution 2010-12, then the Veterans Park Infrastructure and Renovation Non-capital Reserve which has \$300.00 in it, the recommendation is to use this for expenses at the Veterans Park and close the fund.

Cemetery Lights at Mountain View Cemetery, was a fundraiser and there has been no activity on this for over five years. Director Bates spoke with the cemetery department and the intention was for solar lighting at the cemetery the recommendation as there is not enough funds to solar light the entire cemetery is to use it to light up the fountain which has the name of the cemetery, and the flags at the cemetery, the funds would cover this expense. Director Bates explained that this would honor the original intent of the donors.

Mayor Girard understands what finance is recommending but explained when Previous City Solicitor Jane Taylor was here it was made very clear that the people who made the donations didn't want funds being taken out of these trust funds, for example the anti-tank gun was brought to the individual and was very adamant that the money was not to be removed from that account and believes the City will find the same with the Cemetery funds, and wants to be very cautious using someone's donations. As far as the new accounts Mayor Girard agrees the healthcare stabilization makes sense. Mayor Girard noted as far as the assessment goes The Council was told about three years ago the City was putting \$50,000.00 away every year, and there seems to be some confusion. Mayor Girard asked what happened to it or if it fell back into fund balance.

Director Bates stated there is currently no asset account for reevaluations.

Director Bates explained when Council receives funds it can be used with the intention of the donor, it would just take vote from council and noted the DRA and the AG's office stated this as long as the intention is in line with the donation of money.

Councilor Hayden asked about the timeline to see these funds closed, Director Bates noted there is no urgency but wants them cleaned up.

Councilor Hemingway stated he doesn't see these items in the budget book, Director Bates explained these are investment funds not in the budget book.

By consensus the Council agrees to have Finance come back with resolutions and establish the two new funds.

Rolling Stock Inventory, Lease Schedules, and FY26 Fleet Needs

Memorandum

To: Yoshi Manale, Claremont City Manager

From: Nancy Bates, Finance Director

Date: 2025-03-20

Re: Rolling Stock Inventory, Lease Schedule, FY26 Fleet Needs

Attached are 1) rolling stock inventory list, 2) City-Wide lease schedule, and 3) FY26 DPW Fleet needs.

This is for informational purposes only, and no decisions are necessary currently. The intention is not to discuss each individual piece of equipment on the list or being slotted for replacement, that will come later in the budget sessions. This information is presented to get an overall sense of where we are regarding vehicles and equipment and our current lease obligations.

Please note, this is a work in progress, and we are still verifying VINs/titles. This work should be completed by the budget sessions.

We have received the fleet needs list from DPW, the PD is requesting no replacements for FY26, and we are waiting to hear from other departments.

Director Bates explained the rolling stock inventory and noted everything was confirmed with Highway, Water and Sewer, Planning, and working on verifying the rest as this takes time-making sure Vins match, essentially wanted to give a sense of how many vehicles the city has, how many are leased, and how many being recommended to be replaced this year, and the plan is share this information in the Budget Books.

Bond Schedule Review

Memorandum

To: Yoshi Manale, Claremont City Manager

From: Nancy Bates, Finance Director

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Date: 2025-03-20

Re: Bond Schedule Review

Attached is a summary of the City's outstanding bonds and loans with paydown over time, and the total payments due in FY2026, for the Council to review prior to budget sessions.

This is for informational purposes only, and no decisions are necessary currently.

Please note, there is an additional 10-year SRF loan for \$3,469,000 with a 10% principal forgiveness to be added to the schedule in FY2026. The details will be provided once it's converted to a loan.

Director Bates explained the chart and table that gives an overall view of the bonds the city is carrying, which will also be provided in the budget books.

CITY OF CLAREMONT, NH

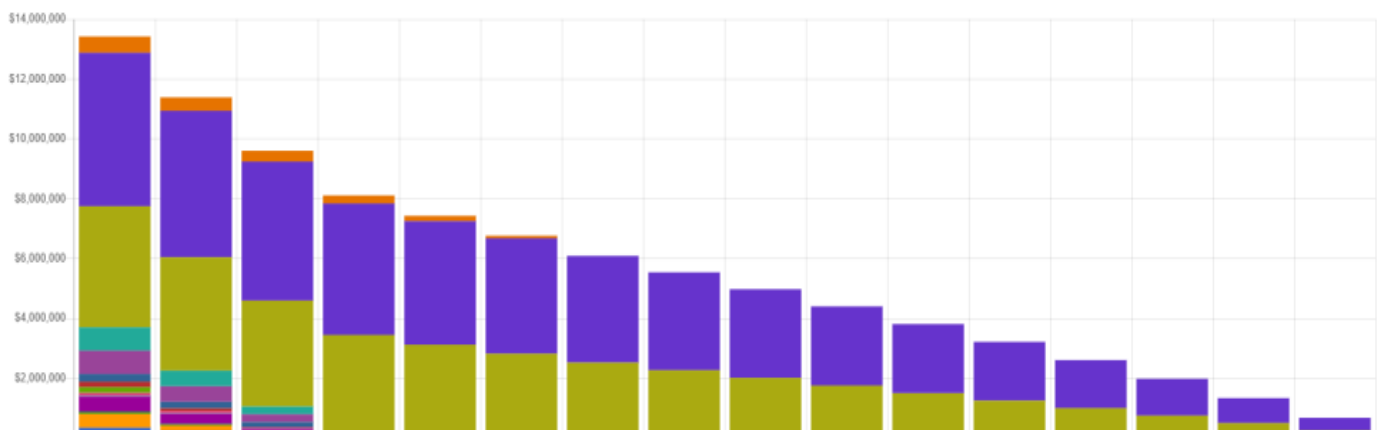
Debt Profile Summary

Profile as of 06/30/2025
Grouped by Type

Series	Dated Date	Final Maturity	Interest Rate	Original Par	Outstanding Par	Outstanding Interest	FY2026 Payment	Purpose	Series Description	Tax Status	Investor
CLEAN WATER SRF LOAN (APPROPRIATE)				7,124,670.48	1,143,690.48	5,987.38					
2008	01/02/2008	12/01/2027	0.38%	335,909.99	84,271.33	402.20	22,451.57	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2008A	01/01/2008	06/01/2027	0.38%	2,707,733.93	507,314.68	3,885.62	177,217.39	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2008B	11/01/2008	01/01/2028	0.38%	108,260.94	20,217.48	154.88	7,983.48	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2009A	01/01/2009	07/01/2028	0.55%	422,539.54	104,460.69	1,454.41	27,801.00	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2017	01/02/2017	04/01/2026	0%	1,878,960.50	187,836.05	0.00	195,124.09	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2022	01/02/2022	04/01/2031	0%	413,906.81	259,590.22	0.00	46,343.55	Wastewater	Clean Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
DRINKING WATER SRF LOAN (APPROPRIATE)				6,793,254.40	996,441.24	20,854.57					
2005	01/01/2005	07/01/2027	1.49%	2,298,361.40	343,197.29	10,815.81	137,622.09	Water	Drinking Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2006	09/30/2006	12/01/2026	1.49%	4,050,000.00	471,428.43	10,036.76	284,653.03	Water	Drinking Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
2021	01/01/2021	08/01/2026	0%	444,843.00	181,815.52	0.00	91,443.33	Water	Drinking Water SRF Loan	Tax-Exempt	State
GENERAL OBLIGATION				21,800,400.00	11,285,000.00	3,039,681.40					
2007B	07/19/2007	08/15/2027	4.0%, 4.25%, 5.0%, 4.75%	4,939,000.00	780,000.00	55,575.00	278,525.00	TIFD	General Obligation Bonds	Tax-Exempt	New Hampshire Municipal Bond Bank
2007B-1	07/19/2007	08/15/2027	5.0%, 4.75%	2,722,000.00	780,000.00	55,575.00	278,525.00	TIFD	General Obligation Bonds	Taxable	New Hampshire Municipal Bond Bank
2011E	12/15/2011	01/15/2041	4.0%, 2.0%, 2.25%, 2.5%	7,452,400.00	5,130,000.00	1,946,356.40	441,968.76	North/Main Street, Community Center and Drapers Corner	General Obligation Bonds	Tax-Exempt	New Hampshire Municipal Bond Bank
2016A	01/14/2016	02/15/2031	4.0%, 2.0%, 2.25%, 2.5%	1,400,000.00	545,000.00	45,650.00	112,775.00	Infrastructure Improvement	General Obligation Bonds	Tax-Exempt	New Hampshire Municipal Bond Bank
2021A	01/06/2021	02/15/2041	5.1%, 3.1%, 2.1%	5,087,000.00	4,050,000.00	936,525.00	391,050.00	Infrastructure Improvement, Communications Dispatch Center	General Obligation Bonds	Tax-Exempt	New Hampshire Municipal Bond Bank
TOTAL				35,918,174.88	13,425,131.69	3,066,523.39	2,492,583.29				

NOTE: Interest rate listed in red is the interest rate for FY26

Outstanding Par Over Time for All Types from 06/30/2025 to 06/30/2041



17 Water Street Carrying Costs

Manager Manale noted it was asked what the ongoing carrying costs would be for the City, so the Finance Director put that together to show exactly what the City would currently owe.

Mayor Girard mentioned a few weeks ago Manager Manale noted to a few councilors the cost for heating and asked if there was a reason why this wasn't included on the list.

Manager Manale stated that the heating costs were paid for upfront, and the closing costs was about \$16,000.00 for the total amount of the oil and can add this.

Mayor Girard stated that it was really important to see all the costs, and believe Councilor Koloski asked for this when first starting this conversation and wants to see all overall costs that are tied up into this building.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked to get a copy of the closing statements.

Councilor Greenrose asked if we are metering the oil so we can tell cost month to month.

Councilor Limoges added the City can call the oil company and get a history.

Mayor Girard stated it was important to see all costs, and shared concern for using fund balance.

Director Bates explained anticipating the costs we have it all encapsulated in a project and running at a negative balance and basically covering the costs with fund balance and will replenish when we sell the property and that was the recommendation of the auditor.

Mayor Girard stated any time money is taken from fund balance it usually comes to the council.

Director Bates tried to explain not using money from fund balance the city is using cash in the bank and running at a negative and then once the project is completed all of it will come to council to see everything and will replenish those funds with the purchase proceeds received, this is a very typical practice.

Councilor Zutter asked what the true number of the fund balance is until the reimbursement.

Director Bates stated that when the auditor does the audit report, she considers everything and will give us a number that includes anything restricted or any requisitions against the account.

Councilor Greenrose asked if there could be a weekly update for fund balance in the managers' report. Councilor Zutter agrees.

Councilor Hemingway wants to see advertising included.

Resolution 2025-42 FY2025 Department of Public Works Leases – Public Hearing

Treasurer, Cathy Parks explained Resolution 2025-42 are for DPW vehicle budgeted for FY25. An excavator, a pick-up truck with plow, a loader, and a meter truck.

In this resolution Ms. Parks stated the finance office did not have the information for the plow and lift on the pickup truck, and the correct total of lending is \$451,794.00.

Mayor Girard asked if these vehicles are at the dealership, Ms. Parks stated two are and the other two need to be ordered.

Mayor Girard stated not being comfortable leasing something not ordered or ready to be picked up.

Director Bates pointed out these have been bid and accepted.

Manager Manale proposed we can get more information from DPW. Ms. Parks suggested splitting the lease.

Councilor O'Hearne would like to wait for more information

Consensus of the Council is to wait for more information.

Mayor Girard asked if the City Manager would like to answer the Citizens Forum question or wait until the next Manager's Report.

Manager Manale noted when the new federal budget wasn't passed, it had two of our projects in it, the congressional delegation lost the funding which was about 1.3 million, \$850,000.00 was

towards our Sugar River Front Project and \$466,000.00 was for developing an entrepreneurship center in our downtown. We are reapplying.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Manager Manale noted the Arts Committee was inquiring about an account set up.

Councilor Greenrose stated the first energy meeting will be in April.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Planning Board approved an ADU on East Green Mountain Road.

Councilor Hayden noted the Conservation is reviewing the handbook, and bylaws, and there will soon be an update on Earth Day events in April.

Councilor O'Hearne noted the Tolles Home is working on rules and regulations for tenants and leases.

Mayor Girard asked about tolles home audit. Director Bates stated all records were requested, and they were cooperative, and given to our auditor. When the city audit report is completed the Tolles Home audit report will be included.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated it was time to think about the City Manager's residency requirement and recalled when searching for the current city manager and wants to be prepared. Assistant Mayor Matteau stated the Council did not do a good job selling it and asked if there is enough time to put it back on to the voters. Assistant Mayor Matteau would like the City Manager to see if we have the timing to put a Charter Amendment Change on the next election. By consensus the Council agrees.

Councilor Hemingway would like for Councilor questions to be spaced out, and the identifying the trustees of trust funds.

Councilor Limoges would like to discuss purchasing neighborhood watch signs.

Councilor O'Hearne wants an update on the Washington St. project. Manager Manale stated we can get a set date for the council.

Councilor O'Hearne would also like an update on the Planning and Development Bronco, and when it will be lettered as a city vehicle.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:26 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Zutter – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro

Clerk to the Council